



Recognize the Divine

Recognize the Divine in Every Person You Encounter Online

JEWISH VALUE

B'tzelem Elohim: Created in the Divine Image

בְּצֶלֶם אֱלֹהִים

“And God created the human in the Divine image”
(Genesis 1:27).

Behind every screen name, profile picture, and comment is a human being who carries that image.

The person on the other end of your screen carries infinite worth and dignity, even when you disagree, even when you can't see their face.

B'tzelem Elohim asks us to look for the Divine in every person we encounter online, and to let that recognition shape how we type, share, and respond.

When the line between real and artificial blurs, holding onto the humanity of the people affected by what we share is an act of radical sacred attention.

What would change about your next comment, post, or share if you truly saw the person on the other end as someone created in the image of God?

WHAT TEENS ARE SAYING

48% of teens say social media has a negative impact on people their age (Pew, 2024). Teens want to feel seen as whole human beings online, not reduced to likes, followers, or a single post.



Guard Your Tongue

Guard Your Tongue: Whether You Type the Words or AI Does

JEWISH VALUE

Shmirat HaLashon: Guarding One's Speech

שמירת הלשון

"Death and life are in the power of the tongue"
(Proverbs 18:21).

Harmful speech, *lashon hara*, can wound as deeply as any weapon. Online, words travel faster, reach further, and last forever.

Do not gossip, shame, mock, or spread rumors, even when you think no one will trace it back to you.

Shmirat halashon extends to AI-assisted communication: if you use a chatbot to draft a message, you are still responsible for every word.

An algorithm cannot absolve you of *lashon hara*. Read what AI writes for you with the same moral care you would give your own words.

Before you hit send, ask: would I say this to someone's face, and does it matter who wrote the words?

WHAT TEENS ARE SAYING

46% of U.S. teens have experienced at least one form of cyberbullying (Pew, 2022). More than half say cyberbullying is a major problem for people their age (Pew, 2024).



Honor and Protect Dignity

Honor and Protect the Dignity of Every Person

JEWISH VALUE

K'vod HaAdam: Human Dignity

כבוד האדם

Do not humiliate anyone publicly. The Talmud teaches that publicly shaming another person is akin to shedding blood (Bava Metzia 58b).

Never share someone else's private images, messages, or personal information without their consent.

Be an upstander, not a bystander. Do not participate in pile-ons, and do not stand silently while someone is being attacked online.

K'vod HaAdam also means refusing to use AI tools to create content that degrades another person: deepfake images, mocking voice imitations, or fabricated screenshots.

The ease of creating such content with AI makes it no less cruel; it makes it more dangerous.

If you saw someone being attacked online right now, what would it take for you to step in?

WHAT TEENS ARE SAYING

Cyberbullying continues to rise among U.S. youth (Cyberbullying Research Center, 2023). AI tools have added new dimensions to harassment. Teens want allies who will speak up.

IV

Be a Mensch

Practice Derech Eretz and Choose Chesed: Be Decent, Be Kind, Be a Mensch

JEWISH VALUES

Derech Eretz: Common Decency • Chesed: Loving-Kindness

דֶּרֶךְ אֶרֶץ • חֶסֶד

The Sages teach that *derech erez*, basic decency and respect, comes before Torah itself (Vayikra Rabbah 9:3).

Be courteous. When you disagree, do so respectfully. Welcome newcomers. Use the same manners you would use face to face.

Jewish tradition also calls us to *chesed*, active loving-kindness. Don't just avoid causing harm; be the person who encourages others.

A kind comment can change someone's entire day.

The most valuable thing you can offer is something no algorithm can produce: genuine human warmth and care.

What is one way you could bring genuine chesed into someone's digital experience today?

WHAT TEENS ARE SAYING

Teens identify miscommunication in non-face-to-face settings as a significant challenge (Montana State, 2024). Fewer teens credit social media as a genuine support system (Pew, 2024).



Seek Truth

Seek Truth: Do Not Spread Falsehood, Do Not Steal What Others Have Created

JEWISH VALUES

Emet: Truth • Geneivat Da'at: Theft of Mind

אֱמֶת • גְּנִיבַת דָּעַת

The Torah commands: “Distance yourself from falsehood” (Exodus 23:7).

Verify before you share. Question what you see. Be honest in your own posts.

Geneivat da'at, literally “theft of the mind,” means deceiving others about the true nature of something.

When AI generates text, art, or music, that output is built on the creative work of real human beings, often without their permission.

Present AI-generated work honestly. Do not claim it as your own creation.

The next time you encounter content online, ask yourself: is this true, who made it, and is that transparent?

WHAT TEENS ARE SAYING

30% of young Americans get their news from social media (Edutopia, 2024). Teens using ChatGPT for schoolwork doubled from 13% to 26% in one year (Pew, 2025).



Protect Privacy

Protect Privacy: What You Share Lives On

JEWISH VALUE

Tzniut: Modesty and Discretion

צניעות

Judaism values modesty and discretion not as restriction but as protection of human dignity.

Guard your personal boundaries online. Once something is shared digitally, you lose control of it.

Your data is valuable: the apps and platforms you use collect, store, and often sell information about you.

Be especially thoughtful about what you share with AI systems. Personal details may be stored and used to train future models.

Tzniut reminds us that not everything needs to be public to be real. “Walk modestly with your God” (Micah 6:8).

Before you share something online or enter it into an AI chatbot, ask: does this need to be shared, and do I know where it goes next?

WHAT TEENS ARE SAYING

74% of teens believe AI platforms should discourage sharing personal information (Common Sense Media, 2025). Yet about a quarter of teen AI companion users have shared personal details.



Take Responsibility

Take Responsibility: True Learning Comes from the Wrestling

JEWISH VALUES

Arevut: Responsibility • Yegi'ah: The Toil of Learning

עֲרֻבוּת • יְגִיעָה

“All Israel are responsible for one another.” *Arevut* means that what we do and create matters beyond ourselves.

Your digital footprint is part of your character. Build it with integrity.

Torah is acquired through human teachers, chevrutah partners, and the hard work of wrestling with ideas (Pirkei Avot 6:6).

AI can hand you a polished answer in seconds, but it cannot give you the experience of arriving at understanding you earned.

There is a difference between using a tool to support your learning and using a tool to skip it.

The next time AI offers you a quick answer, ask: what would I learn by wrestling with this myself?

WHAT TEENS ARE SAYING

54% of teens say using ChatGPT for research is acceptable, but only 18% say the same for writing essays (Pew, 2025).



Observe Digital Shabbat

Observe Digital Shabbat: Create Sacred Boundaries with Technology

JEWISH VALUE

Shabbat: Sacred Rest and Boundaries

שַׁבָּת

On the seventh day, God finished the work of creation and rested (Genesis 2:2). Practice stepping away from your screens.

Set intentional boundaries around your device use. You are more than your online presence.

AI companions are designed to be always available, always agreeable, and always engaging, which makes disconnection harder but more necessary.

Not everyone has equal access to the human support they need. For some, AI tools and online communities can offer real connection.

Shabbat asks us to be intentional about when we use technology and when we rest from it.

What would it look like for you to practice a digital Shabbat, even for an hour?

WHAT TEENS ARE SAYING

44% of teens report trying to cut back on social media (Pew, 2024). 72% have tried AI companions, with a third saying it feels as good as talking to a real friend (Common Sense Media, 2025).



Pursue Digital Justice

Pursue Digital Justice: Build a World That Leaves No One Behind

JEWISH VALUE

Tzedek: Justice and Righteousness



“Justice, justice shall you pursue” (Deuteronomy 16:20).

Tzedek demands that we look beyond our own experience and ask: who is missing?

Not everyone has consistent access to the internet, a working device, or the subscriptions that unlock the tools others take for granted.

When we build Jewish spaces online without thinking about accessibility, we close doors that should be open.

AI tools hold promise for bridging gaps: translating languages, generating captions, supporting different learning styles. But only if access is itself just and equitable.

Before you build, post, or share, ask: who is this leaving out, and what can I do about it?

WHAT TEENS ARE SAYING

The gap between high-income and low-income teens in AI use reached 24 percentage points in 2025, double the 2024 gap (CARE/USC, 2025).



Repair the World

Use Your Online Presence to Repair the World

JEWISH VALUES

Tikkun Olam: Repairing the World • Bal Tashchit: Do Not Destroy

תקון עולם • בל תשחית

Every post, share, and comment is an opportunity for *tikkun*, repair. Use your platform to uplift, educate, advocate, and create.

The digital world is not separate from the real world; what you do online shapes the world we all share.

Our digital choices have a physical cost. AI systems consume enormous amounts of energy and water.

The Torah forbids cutting down fruit trees even in wartime (Deuteronomy 20:19). *Bal tashchit* calls us to use powerful tools mindfully.

Share content that builds up rather than tears down.

Ask yourself: is this use of technology truly serving tikkun, or is it just convenience at the world's expense?

WHAT TEENS ARE SAYING

Many teens say social media helps them find creative inspiration (Pew, 2024). Teens increasingly care about environmental responsibility and their digital footprint.